Animals and biology

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Animal behavior and survival (179 words)

Life on Earth is divided into millions of **species**, each adapted to its own conditions. The relationship between **predator** and **prey** drives much of this variety: a **carnivore** must hunt to survive, while a **herbivore** relies on speed, numbers or **camouflage** to escape. Some creatures are **nocturnal**, hunting only at night, and others **hibernate** through the cold months to save energy.

Much behavior is guided by **instinct** rather than learning. Birds **migrate** thousands of kilometers with no map, and a female will protect her **offspring** until they can fend for themselves. Social species live in a **colony**, where roles are shared among thousands of individuals. Every **organism** has a **gene** code that shapes its body and habits, and over generations the process of **evolution** helps a population to **adapt** to a changing habitat.

Every **mammal** feeds its young on milk, while other groups **reproduce** by laying eggs. People have **brought under control** certain animals since early times: dogs and sheep were **domesticated** long ago. The greatest threat today is **extinction**, which is why scientists **keep track of** numbers in the wild.

Useful phrases from the article

PHRASE	MEANING
brought under control	tamed
keep track of	follow closely

The 20 new words

WORD		MEANING	EXAMPLE
species	n	a kind of living thing	*Thousands of species live in the rainforest.*
predator	n	an animal that hunts others	*The lion is a powerful predator.*
prey	n	an animal that is hunted	*Rabbits are the main prey of foxes.*
migrate	v	to travel to another region each year	*Birds migrate south in winter.*
hibernate	v	to sleep through the winter	*Bears hibernate in caves.*
offspring	n	the young of an animal	*The female protects her offspring.*
evolution	n	slow change in living things over time	*Evolution explains how species adapt.*
adapt	v	to change to live in new conditions	*Camels adapt to desert heat.*

nocturnal	adj	active at night	*Owls are nocturnal birds.*
herbivore	n	an animal that eats plants	*Cows are herbivores.*
carnivore	n	an animal that eats meat	*The wolf is a carnivore.*
instinct	n	natural behavior not learned	*Birds build nests by instinct.*
camouflage	n	colors that help hide an animal	*The frog uses camouflage to avoid danger.*
mammal	n	an animal that feeds its young milk	*Whales are mammals, not fish.*
reproduce	v	to produce young	*Fish reproduce in large numbers.*
organism	n	a living thing	*A single cell is the simplest organism.*
gene	n	a part of a cell that controls traits	*Eye color depends on genes.*
extinction	n	the complete disappearance of a species	*Habitat loss leads to extinction.*
colony	n	a group of animals living together	*An ant colony can have millions of members.*
domesticate	v	to tame an animal for human use	*Dogs were domesticated thousands of years ago.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

WORD		MEANING
excavation	n	digging to find old objects
artifact	n	an object made by people long ago
ancient	adj	very old, from long ago
civilization	n	an advanced society
settlement	n	a place where people start to live
ruins	n	the broken remains of buildings
dynasty	n	a line of rulers from one family
empire	n	a group of countries ruled by one power
trade route	n	a path used for buying and selling goods
inscription	n	writing carved on stone

Practice: fill the gaps

extinction · migrate · domesticate · adapt · colony · predator · mammal · hibernate

1. Habitat loss leads to _____.
2. Birds _____ south in winter.
3. Dogs were _____ thousands of years ago.

4. Camels _____ to desert heat.
5. An ant _____ can have millions of members.
6. The lion is a powerful _____.
7. Whales are _____, not fish.
8. Bears _____ in caves.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

amphibian (n): an animal that lives on land and in water
ape (n): a large tailless primate
bacteria (n): tiny single-celled organisms
beak (n): the hard mouth of a bird
breed (v): to produce young
burrow (n): a hole dug by an animal
cold-blooded (adj): with a body temperature that changes
dolphin (n): a clever sea mammal
endangered (adj): at risk of extinction
feed on (v): to eat as food
flock (n): a group of birds
food chain (n): a series of living things that eat each other
fur (n): the hair of an animal
hatch (v): to come out of an egg
herd (n): a group of large animals
insect (n): a small creature with six legs
invertebrate (n): an animal without a backbone
life cycle (n): the stages of life
lizard (n): a small reptile
nest (n): a home built by a bird
pack (n): a group of wolves or dogs
parasite (n): a creature that lives on another
pest (n): an animal that harms crops
pollinate (v): to carry pollen between flowers
reptile (n): a cold-blooded animal such as a snake
scavenger (n): an animal that eats dead animals
shell (n): a hard covering
swarm (n): a large group of insects
vertebrate (n): an animal with a backbone
wildlife (n): wild animals

Answers

1. extinction (extinction)
2. migrate (migrate)
3. domesticated (domesticate)
4. adapt (adapt)
5. colony (colony)
6. predator (predator)
7. mammals (mammal)
8. hibernate (hibernate)